

can also search to find articles and discussion threads of interest. Discussion groups in general provide a forum for your site's visitors to communicate with each other. These forums can be used to harvest feedback from your customers or gauge interest in new products or services.

While discussion groups are usually open to everyone visiting the Web site, with FrontPage 2002 it is also possible to set-up secure and private discussion groups, limited to certain users who must register and log in to the discussion on the Web site. These private, secure discussion groups can be used to help your employees, partners, and suppliers collaborate on projects, brainstorm ideas, refine documents, just to name a few.

Using Microsoft SharePoint Team Services (a technology included with FrontPage 2002), it is possible to create special types of discussion groups called "Web document discussions" where users, working together on the same information, can discuss it by attaching comments directly to team Web pages and documents. This type of discussion group is available only on Webs hosted by Web servers running SharePoint Team Services. To find out more about SharePoint Team Services, see Microsoft Resources at the end of this article.

Setting Up a Discussion Group in FrontPage 2002

A discussion group makes a Web site highly interactive because it allows site visitors to discuss topics online about articles or comments that have been posted to the site, and gives them the opportunity to reply, as well as post new articles or comments. Visitors can also search to find articles and discussion threads of interest. Discussion groups in general provide a forum for your site's visitors to communicate with each other. These forums can be used to harvest feedback from your customers or gauge interest in new products or services.

While discussion groups are usually open to everyone visiting the Web site, with FrontPage 2002 it is also possible to set-up